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Why I finally left Spotify

After our decade-long relationship, I'm breaking up with Spotify.

It's nothing personal. It's just that Spotify and I have grown up, but we haven't grown together.

Over the years, I've been tempted to leave Spotify many times. I know that the company faces accusations of [poor streaming payouts](#) for artists compared to its competitors, and I haven't forgotten that it was Spotify that platformed Joe Rogan's podcast, then exclusive to the platform, to spread [misinformation](#) about COVID-19 and other viruses.

I know that Spotify is trying to [kill the RSS feed](#), a move that [siphons independence](#) from podcasters.

And yet, I'm embarrassed to say that until recently, these issues didn't move me enough to take the time and energy to investigate alternatives to Spotify, a platform that I've been using daily since high school.

It's unfortunately easy for us to bury our heads in the sand when the tech companies we pay monthly do things that disappoint us. (Yes, I still remember when Netflix [laid off my industry colleagues](#), but I also know I'll end up watching the new season of "Love Is Blind.")

We don't feel like our one subscription makes a difference — after all, [Duolingo](#) still beat revenue

IMAGE CREDITS:

PAINT BY DREW SPOTTS FOR MMS BY THE DOWNSIDE
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estimates after sparking a backlash when it said it would replace contractors with AI.

But Spotify finally got to me in a way that's unavoidable: When I open the app, I cannot bear its all-encompassing, suffocating reliance on algorithmic recommendations.

There's an overwhelming display of visual clutter from the time it takes to navigate from Spotify's home page to the music you're looking for. These suggestions are front and center when you open the app.

First, I may see an unsolicited, full-screen pop-up promoting a new podcast. Then I'm greeted with a 2-by-4 grid of music and podcast suggestions, including new episodes of shows I listened to once because they had a guest I liked, plus some other albums that I've dabbled in briefly over the last month or so. Below that, there's a sponsored recommendation for a song I might like by an artist that I have never heard of. When I navigate to the search tab, I'm prompted with an audiobook recommendation, and if I scroll a little bit, I see vertical video clips that look like they belong on TikTok.

It's easy to fall into Spotify's recommendations, as the app constantly pelts you with customized playlists that its AI has curated specifically for you. On Spotify, you never have to make any decisions — and for some listeners, maybe that's the point. But I noticed that I stopped listening to the music I actually wanted to listen to, and instead, I embraced the music that Spotify told me I wanted to listen to.

Without realizing it, I gave up my agency.

This isn't to say that my moral qualms with Spotify didn't influence my choice.

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- Why I finally left Spotify

According to a January [report](#) from the music financing platform Duetti, Spotify, a company worth about \$140 billion, pays about \$3 per 1,000 streams. Amazon Music, Apple Music, and YouTube paid \$8.80, \$6.20, and \$4.80, respectively, per 1,000 streams in 2024. (Spotify [previously disputed the accuracy](#) of these figures.)

Spotify further alienated a portion of its audience in June, when CEO Daniel Ek announced that his investment firm led a nearly [\\$700 million funding round](#) for a company making AI-enabled military weapons. Some bands like [Deerhoof](#), [Xiu Xiu](#), and [King Gizzard & the Lizard Wizard](#) pulled their catalogs from Spotify in protest.

It's like déjà vu. In 2022, Joni Mitchell and Neil Young pulled their music from Spotify over Joe Rogan's platforming of medical misinformation. (The two artists returned to the platform in 2024.)

Perhaps it's taken me so long to leave Spotify because choosing a streaming platform leaves you between a rock and a hard place. But if you're attached to your years of playlists, tools like [Soundiiz](#) make it easy to port your collection between platforms.

I chose Apple Music, mostly because I got a new iPhone and it came with a three-month free trial, which helped me ease my transition. Also, Apple Music has lossless audio, which Spotify has been [promising for nearly five years](#).

But I cannot tell you with a straight face that I have departed big, bad Spotify to support the little guy, when I've opted for another tech giant.

I have my ethical concerns around Apple, too — even as I type this on my Magic Keyboard that's connected to my MacBook Pro while my iPhone,

AirPods, and Apple Watch sit on the other side of my desk.

Plus, Apple CEO Tim Cook recently showed up at the White House to gift Donald Trump with a [custom, Apple-branded plaque](#), which sits atop a 24-karat gold base, while performing his fiduciary duty to shareholders to keep Apple products tariff-free.

At least the Apple Music app isn't as overwhelming as Spotify.

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Amanda Silberling

Senior Writer |

Amanda Silberling is a senior writer at TechCrunch covering the intersection of technology and culture. She has also...

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Spotify's latest feature lets you add your own transitions to playlists

Sarah Perez — 3:00 AM PDT · August 19, 2025



Spotify is **introducing** a new feature that allows subscribers to create more professional, personalized playlists. Today, the company launched a custom mix tool, a feature that lets you either automatically add transitions between a playlist's tracks or customize your own using preset options like fade, rise, or blend, along with other options.

To use the feature, open any playlist and select "Mix" from the toolbar to begin editing. While customizing the track with different transition styles, you can also adjust settings for things like the volume, EQ, and effects, and use the waveform and beat data to find the best spot in each track to begin the transition.

Spotify notes that it will automatically display the key and the beats per minute for each track, to make it easier for novice audio mixers to get started.

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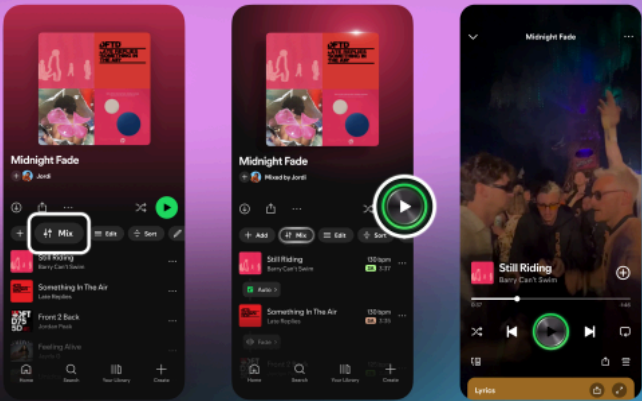


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IMAGE CREDITS: SPOTIFY

The new options are designed to appeal to playlist experts and other music fans, who have collectively created nearly 9 billion playlists on Spotify’s platform to date.

The rollout complements other updates Spotify has launched over the past year that give users more control over their listening experience, the company says, like the tools to [add, sort, and edit playlists](#), [customize the genre of the Discover Weekly](#) playlist, [snooze tracks](#), [make voice requests to the AI DJ](#), and more. It also allows Spotify to compete with Apple Music’s [upcoming](#) AutoMix feature, which is currently live in the iOS 26 developer beta, and claims to let you mix “like a DJ.”

Premium subscribers with access to the transitions feature will also be able to save and share the playlist with other friends on social media or even invite other subscribers to collaborate on a mixed playlist.

The mix can be toggled on and off at any time by pressing the “mix” option, allowing you to turn your playlist back to the more traditional kind when the party or gym workout (or wherever else you’re streaming the mix) has ended.

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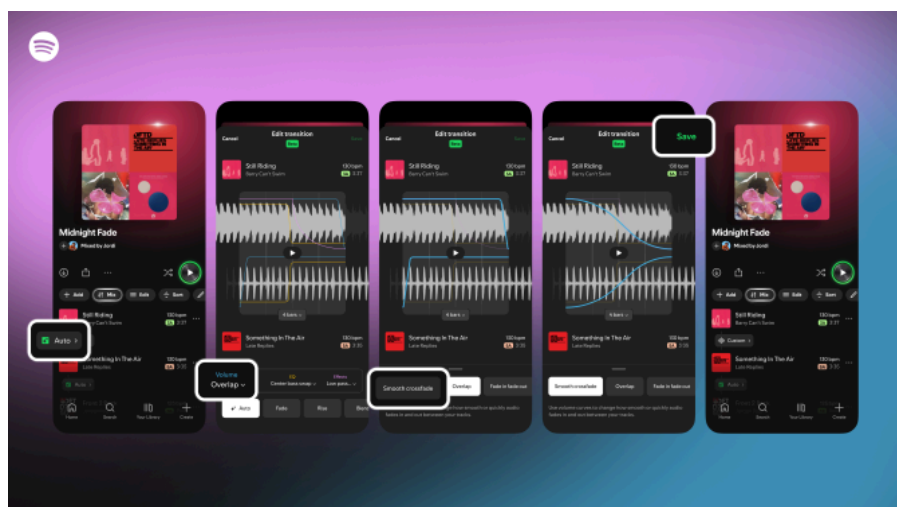


IMAGE CREDITS: SPOTIFY

The company recommends that mixing works best with music that’s already been produced for seamless transitions, like house and techno, which tend to blend more easily.

Like other playlists, the mixes can be further [customized using your own cover art](#) along with newly added stickers and labels made just for mixed playlists.

Custom transitions in playlists are available starting today for the majority of eligible Premium users worldwide. (The company says some markets in the APAC region will still need to wait for the addition.) The feature is rolling out gradually to users who have updated their Spotify app for iOS or Android.

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Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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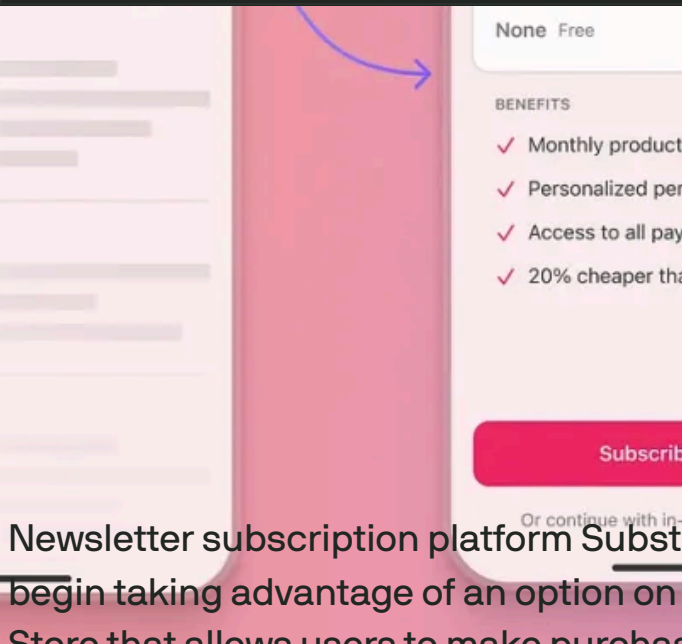


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Sarah Perez — 10:16 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

Newsletter subscription platform Substack will begin taking advantage of an option on the U.S. App Store that allows users to make purchases outside of Apple's in-app purchasing system. This functionality is permitted by a [change to the App Store's rules in May](#), as a result of [Epic Games' antitrust lawsuit](#) against the tech giant.

Since then, a number of top apps have moved to offer in-app purchase links that point to their own websites, including [Spotify](#), [Patreon](#), and the [Amazon Kindle](#) app, among others.

In Substack's case, support for external payments will benefit both the company, which no longer has to pay the App Store a commission on those web sales, and consumers, who will have access to reduced pricing. Meanwhile, Substack creators will be able to offer their readers the option of whether they want the convenience of Apple's in-app payments system (IAP) or the web payment option,

which is now accessible without having to leave the app.

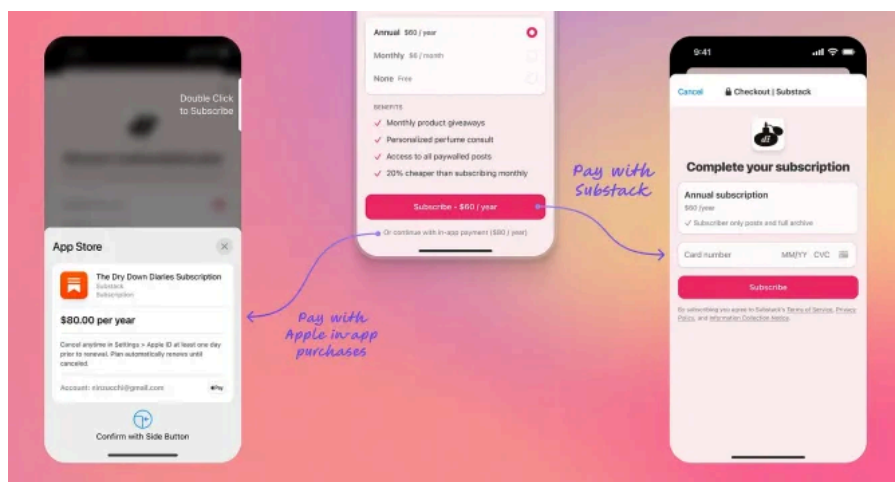
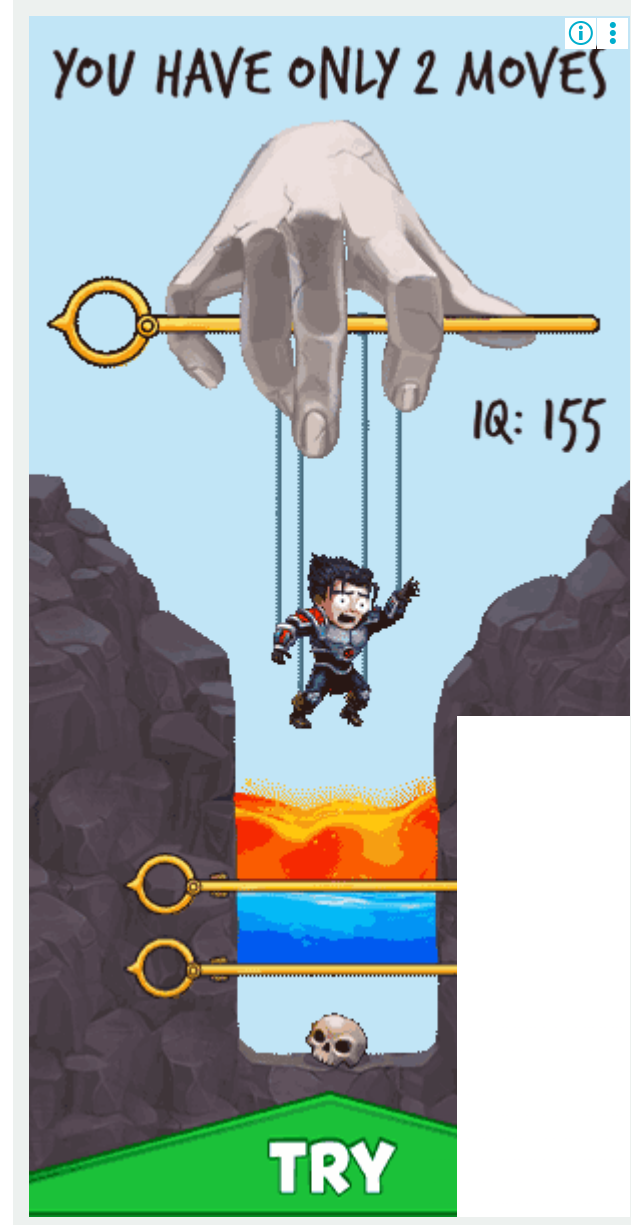


IMAGE CREDITS: SUBSTACK

Substack explains it will automatically adjust its customers' iOS app price higher to account for Apple's fees, allowing creators to take home the same amount of money as a web subscription. However, Substack writers can disable this feature if they choose. (Substack will continue to take its own 10% fee based on the web subscription price, as before.)

The company said in its blog post that it's also offering its writers "migration tools." We originally reported that these could help migrate users from one payments platform to another, but Substack reached out to correct this. Instead, it said that the tools are meant to help creators access billing information for Apple-managed subscriptions if they ever leave the platform.

Currently, more than 30,000 publications on the platform have in-app purchases enabled; Substack says early tests of the expanded set of payment options have driven a boost in paid sign-ups. It did not, however, share specific numbers related to this.



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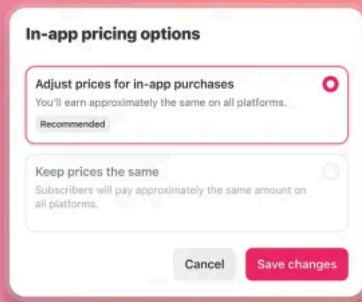


IMAGE CREDITS: SUBSTACK

The public launch of the external payments option will only impact new Substack subscriptions. Substack writers don't have to take any action unless they want to lower the prices for those using Apple's payments system.

Per Apple's App Store rules, fully opting out of offering IAP is not allowed.

While the changes impact the Substack app in the U.S., the company says it's still evaluating if it makes sense to switch to the more complex rules Apple offers in the EU and U.K. for developers who want to forgo IAP.

Updated after publication to correct and clarify how the migration tools work.

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iPhone 17, the ‘thinnest iPhone ever,’ and everything else we’re expecting out of Apple’s hardware event

Apple usually announces its new hardware in the fall, and this year is likely no different. The event is reported to be on September 9, and Apple is expected to release its iPhone 17 lineup along with updates for the Apple Watch and AirPods.

As always, there are many rumors circulating, including bigger screens and improved cameras for the iPhone 17 models and the introduction of an ultra-thin iPhone Air that could replace the Plus model.

iPhone 17, 17 Pro, and 17 Pro Max

IMAGE CREDITS: CHENG XIN / GETTY IMAGES

The iPhone 17 is expected to get a significant makeover to align more closely with the Pro models. It could feature a slightly larger [6.3-inch screen](#), which is an increase of 0.2 inches compared to the iPhone 16, as well as a [120Hz display](#), a substantial upgrade from the current 60Hz. It's also rumored to have a 24-megapixel front camera. It could also come in new colors: purple and green.

iPhone 17: Purple and Green Colors in Testing as Potential New Shade for 2025

Full Article: <https://t.co/jZJJoUHBsf>
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— Majin Bu (@MajinBuOfficial) [June 20, 2025](#)

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The Pro's upgrades will be noticeable on the back of the phone, rumors suggest. [Conceptual renderings](#) show that the three rear cameras may be arranged in a rectangular bar that extends from one edge of the device to the other. The flash, light sensor, and microphone would be positioned far to the right side. Where the MagSafe charger is, the Apple logo is said to be centered for aesthetic reasons.

Notably, the iPhone 17 Pro may switch materials, potentially replacing the titanium band around the screen with aluminum. This could help Apple reduce costs as well as provide a lighter feel.

The iPhone 17 Pro Max is expected to see fewer upgrades, too, with the most significant change being a slightly thicker body, likely to accommodate a larger battery — which would be a huge win.

According to [leaker Instant Digital](#), the iPhone 17 is predicted to be priced around \$800, and the Pro Max is expected to have a price tag of \$1,250. New colors for the Pro models potentially include [dark blue and copper](#).

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The Pro model is expected to be priced around \$1,050. However, a [recent leak](#) indicates that there will be fewer storage options compared to the 16 Pro. Users may lose the 128GB option and will only have three choices: 256GB, 512GB, or 1TB, down from the typical four options.

iPhone Air

IMAGE CREDITS:APPLE TRACK

The most widely discussed rumor is that Apple might be introducing its slimmest phone ever, [the iPhone Air](#), which may replace the iPhone Plus.

This rumored device is said to have a profile thickness of 5.5 mm, making it about 0.08 inches thinner than current iPhones. It'll also feature a 6.6-inch screen.

This move appears to be Apple's response to the trend of slimmer smartphones, following in the footsteps of other companies like Samsung and Huawei. The iPhone Air could potentially outshine the Samsung Galaxy S25 Edge, which measures 5.8 mm thick. Additionally, it may pave the way for [Apple's long-rumored foldable phone](#), predicted to launch in September 2026.

While the thin design is stylish, it would come with some compromises. Based on the [renders](#) we've seen, the Air is expected to have only one rear camera lens, unlike the Plus, which has two. There are also [rumors](#) that there may not be enough space for a speaker at the bottom, meaning the only audio source could be the front earpiece at the top.

Reports suggest the device will be priced at \$950 and will be available in black, silver, and light gold.

Apple Watch Series 11, Ultra 3, and SE 3

IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

After a two-year wait, there are various rumors surrounding the Apple Watch Ultra 3, suggesting it will undergo significant changes. These may include faster charging speeds, 5G support, and satellite connectivity. Additionally, it's speculated that the watch will feature a [larger display](#).

One of the most exciting potential upgrades for both the Ultra 3 and Series 11 is the incorporation of blood pressure monitoring capabilities. This feature would notify users if their blood pressure levels are too high or too low. Apple is also considering adding a sleep apnea feature. However, according to Bloomberg's Mark Gurman, the company [may need to delay the release of these features for further tweaks](#).

Apple recently announced that a [redesigned blood oxygen feature](#) is rolling out to some Series 8, 10, and Ultra watches. This leads us to think the Ultra 3 may also get the capability, but the company didn't mention if it would be available in the watchOS 26 in its announcement.

The third generation of Apple Watch SE isn't expected to receive major updates, aside from possibly a larger display. There continue to be reports of a plastic version being introduced, according to Gurman.

Rumored prices for the watches are: \$250 for the Apple Watch SE 3, \$400 for the Series 11, and \$800 for the Ultra 3.

AirPods Pro 3

After the release of the AirPods Pro 2 in 2022, it's about time for an upgrade, and Apple might just be ready to deliver. [Rumors](#) suggest that the AirPods Pro 3 will feature a sleeker design, touch-sensitive controls, smaller earbuds, and a slimmer case. Additionally, the H3 chip is expected to enhance active noise cancellation and adaptive audio.

This story has been updated to include additional rumors.

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